Vasudha Ramakrishna

Boston University · Department of Economics
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Education

Boston University, Boston, MA — 2022 – Present
Ph.D. in Economics

Tufts University, Medford, MA — 2018 – 2020
M.S. in Economics

University of Mumbai, Mumbai, India — 2013 – 2016
B.A. in Economics & Statistics

Research Fields

Economic History, Development Economics, Political Economy

Publications

- Meriggi, N.F., Voors, M., Levine, M., **Ramakrishna, V.**, et al. (2024). "Last-mile delivery increases vaccine uptake in Sierra Leone." *Nature*, 627, 612–619. (Link)
- Levine, M., Meriggi, N.F., Mobarak, A.M., **Ramakrishna, V.**, Voors, M., & Wadehra, U. (2023). "Gendered Disparities during the COVID-19 Crisis in Sierra Leone." *AEA Papers and Proceedings*, 113: 567-71. (Link)
- Solís Arce, J.S., Warren, S.S., Meriggi, N.F., **Ramakrishna, V.**, et al. (2021). "COVID-19 vaccine acceptance and hesitancy in low- and middle-income countries." *Nature Medicine*, 27, 1385–1394. (Link)

Research in Progress

- **Heart sellers: Impact of Asian Immigrant Doctors on US Health**
- **The Costs of Service: Short- and Long-Term Effects of WWII Injuries** (with Micheal Briskin anf Yicheng Chen)
- **Equal Access Unequal Outcomes? Higher Education Quotas in Elite Indian Engineering Colleges** (with Samira Adhar)
- **The Hold Up Problem in Death Registration: Evidence from Ghana**

Fellowships and Awards

Weiss Fund Piloting Grant, 2026

EHA Early Dissertation Fellowship, 2026

IGC Special Project Facility Grant (with David Lagakos), 2025, and 2024

IOEA (Institutional and Organizational Economics Academy) Best Project Award, May 2025

Summer in the Field Fellowship, Boston University, 2024; 2026

Abdala Fellowship: fieldwork grant, Boston University, 2024; 2026

Tobin Pre-Doctoral Fellowship, Yale University, 2020 – 2022

Tufts University Masters Tuition Waiver, 2018 – 2020

Research Experience

Yale University July 2020 – July 2022

Research Assistant to Professor Ahmed Mushfiq Mobarak

- Managed large-scale RCTs in Sierra Leone and Bangladesh; designed BDM auction experiments and wrote pre-analysis plans.
- Conducted power analyses, sampling strategies, and high-frequency data quality checks.
- Co-authored grant applications, concept notes, and reports for major funders.

Tufts University Jan 2019 – May 2020

Graduate Research Assistant to Professors Jenny Aker, Kyle Emerick, Cynthia Kinnan, & Elizabeth Setren

Teaching Experience

Boston University, Teaching Fellow Sept 2023 – May 2024

Introductory Microeconomic Analysis, Masters Capstone Class

Tufts University, Grader Jan 2019 – May 2019

Ec 15: Basic Econometrics (Developed solution keys and Stata exercises)

Service

- **Referee**, *Journal of Political Economy*
- **Co-Chair**, Women and Nonbinary People in Economics, Boston University (2023–2025). Organized WERISE Conference (2025)
- **Organizer** for Graduate Student Workshop in Economic History, Boston University and Harvard University (2026-2027)
- **Panelist**, "Human Capital & Development: Resources for Students and the BU Community," Global Development Policy Center, Boston University, April 2026.
- **Union Representative**, Boston University Graduate Students Union

Skills & Languages

Programming: Stata, Python, R, LaTeX, ArcGIS, SurveyCTO, ODK

Languages: English (Native), Hindi (Fluent), Tamil (Fluent)